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Logging in with LogMeIn

We speak with LogMeIn about their plans to integrate AI into their services

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Q Could you detail what your latest acquisitions are all about?

Rahul: In the last year, we've made a couple of significant acquisitions. One of them was an AI-technology company based out of Israel, their product has a beautiful NLP engine. We've been thinking of exciting ways of implementing AI in all of our products. The basic technology powers the Bold360 but we're thinking of AI that can actually come into every part of our business. As an example, we have an online meeting on GoToMeetings, the AI engine will automatically translate the speech into text and it'll have the notes ready for you. The end goal is to come out with something called a Smart Assist which can reside in your meeting and help you with your pre-meeting scenario.

As an example, if you were to fix up a call between two individuals, it'll scan through their calendars and come up with the appropriate time slots. During the meeting it will produce the notes. And after the meeting, it can send out a summary of the conversation with the summary including the action items, stakeholders responsible for each item, the decided timelines and then continue with follow-ups.

There are similar use cases emerging for each and every product of ours where we can embed an AI. The other exciting acquisition was Jive Communications, a cloud telephony company. We're basically integrating that with our unified collaboration suite so that it can allow an organisation to have online meetings and then expand that to the existing telephony infrastructure. Currently, an organisation might have multiple infrastructures within the organisation, say by providing mobiles to employees, fixed lines and IP-based telephony. So, how do you get a consolidated view of these three? That's what Jive does and we're working on integrating that within our unified collaboration suite.

Q Some of the features that you've mentioned regarding Bold360 was already demonstrated at Google I/O as new features being integrated into Google Assistant. And Google Suite also opened up the Hangouts and Meet API to conferencing hardware solutions from the likes of Avaya, Cisco, etc. using Pexip. Given that an entity as large as Google is already entrenched into most offices and has competing services, how do you plan on differentiating your services?

Rahul: I think they're on the same track that we're on. When you think of collaboration as a market, the Total Addressable size of that market is huge. There will be a lot of other players who'll be in that space with unique USPs that they'll bring in to the market. The USP that we believe that we solve for is that we are an enterprise-grade product. So if you were to have a 200-people conference call, then some of the technologies that were built for consumers may not have the ability to provide that scale.

Q With the current digitisation drive, there's a growing market for e-KYC. Are there any efforts to address that, given that you're into identity management as well?

Rahul: We've expanded LastPass with the acquisition of NoPassword. NoPassword came in with built-in capabilities of multi-factor authentication, privilege access management and single sign-on. The LastPass suite is now integrated with all these technologies and then there are integrations with about 1200 cloud applications so you don't have to write APIs for all these integrations. This is complementing whatever on-premise solution you may have.

Q Are there any Government initiative that you're involved in?

Rahul: Currently we're not engaged with the Government or with any policy making. We do have partners who have taken our products to them but those are mostly on the edges. We don't have a strategy to work closely with the Government. We are looking at some of the policies closely, one of which is how the Indian Data Protection Law shapes up. **d**